

ComposePro — Research & Product Doc (Notion-friendly)

Use toggles for each section in Notion. Below are ready-to-paste sections.

► Market Context (why this matters now)

- Smartphone users take ~1,440 photos/year on average; 75% of all photos come from smartphones; 68% are shared on social within 24 hours. [134]
- 52% edit almost every photo before sharing; 30% use AI-powered editing tools. [133]
- Beginners consistently cite composition as the hardest skill to internalize (subject placement, horizon, angle, distractions). [5][33][65][75]
- Live, in-the-moment coaching is emerging because post-capture fixes can't recover bad framing; users want help before they press the shutter. [22][41][45][55][59]

► User Personas

► Persona A: "Social Sharer" (smartphone-first hobbyist)

- Who: 18–34, students/young professionals, heavy social users (Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp). [132][134]
- Goals: Consistently better everyday photos (friends, food, travel) with minimal effort; look competent without learning jargon. [7][8][75]
- Behaviors: Shoot in auto, use grid sparingly, edit quickly (presets/AI), share same day. [132][133][134]
- Composition pains: Centered subjects, tilted horizons, messy backgrounds, no look room, shooting only from eye level. [5][33][65][75][79]
- Willingness to pay: Low-moderate; responds to transparent pricing, no watermark, clear "before/after" value. [60][62][71][74]

► Persona B: "Travel & Food Creator" (aspiring micro-influencer)

- Who: 22–40, content creators, travel bloggers, foodies building a personal brand. [134]
- Goals: Consistent aesthetics across posts; reliable framing for stories/reels; faster workflow on the go. [134]
- Behaviors: Plans shots, uses multiple lenses (ultra-wide/tele), edits with presets, tracks engagement. [134]
- Composition pains: Inconsistent subject placement across posts, sky/land balance in landscapes, clutter in food frames, poor angle to light. [5][33][63][67][75]

- Willingness to pay: Moderate; pays for tools that improve consistency and speed (genre presets, light-direction prompts). [71][73][74][76]

► Persona C: "Enthusiast Upgrader" (mirrorless/DSLR hobbyist)

- Who: 25–50, weekend shooters, camera club members, aspiring pros. [110][114][116]
- Goals: Deliberate practice, measurable improvement, genre-specific mastery (portrait/landscape/street). [110][112][114][137]
- Behaviors: Shoots in manual, reviews EXIF, joins critiques, invests in courses/gear over time. [114][137]
- Composition pains: Breaking plateaus, applying rules in dynamic scenes, cleaning backgrounds, choosing angles/height intentionally. [5][33][43][65][67]
- Willingness to pay: Moderate–high; values progress analytics, challenges, and reliable coaching over flashy features. [16][22][41][71][74]

► Persona D: "Local Pro" (paid gigs: portraits, products, food)

- Who: 28–55, part-time/full-time pros serving local clients. [137][139]
- Goals: Faster setup on shoots, fewer reshoots, consistent client results. [137]
- Behaviors: Uses genre-specific workflows, light modifiers, RAW editing, portfolios. [137][139]
- Composition pains: Time pressure leading to framing mistakes, distracting backgrounds, inconsistent eye placement/horizon across sets. [5][33][65][67]
- Willingness to pay: High if it reduces reshoots and improves consistency; prefers annual/lifetime plans. [71][74][76][81]

► Needs (Functional, Emotional, Social)

► Functional Needs

- Show me exactly where to place the subject and horizon right now (dots/lines, snap-to-guide). [45][46][50][56][79]
- Tell me how to angle relative to light (front/side/back) and what to do about distractions. [65][67]
- Keep it visual and fast (3–6 word cues, overlays), not long explanations. [47][50][55]
- Offer genre presets (Portrait/Landscape/Street/Food/Product) with different priorities. [5][33][43][67]

► Emotional Needs

- Confidence: "I can get a good shot in 10 seconds." [32][40][75]
- Control: "I know why this frame works." [113][135]
- Progress: "I can see improvement week to week." [1][41][135]

► Social Needs

- Shareable results: before/after carousels that signal growth. [134][136]
- Community validation: challenges, streaks, badges. [1][41][124]

► Pain Points (Evidence-Backed)

- Observational gap: composition is less technical and more about seeing—slowing down, scanning corners, simplifying, making intentional placements. [32][43][113]
- Repeated framing errors: centered static subjects, messy backgrounds, mergers, no look room, tilted horizons, eye-level-only shots. [5][33][38][43][65][67][75][79]
- Passive learning: articles/videos don't help in the moment; users want live cues before capture. [22][41][55][59]
- App distrust: aggressive upsells, watermarks, confusing auto-renewals, unreliable AI. [16][23][27][30][60][62][66]
- Battery/latency fears: continuous AI drains battery and lags the shutter. [78][86][93]

► Opportunities (Product & Positioning)

- Own the "in-the-moment" niche: deterministic overlays + horizon level first, then layer AI coaching with confidence indicators. [45][47][60][62]
- Light-direction coaching: explicit prompts to shift subject relative to light (side/back/front) and angle/height nudges—beyond just grids. [65][67][75]
- Genre-specific paths: Portrait (eye on upper third + look room), Landscape (foreground interest + horizon placement), Food (overhead 45

► User Journeys (End-to-End)

► Journey 1: Social Sharer (first 7 days)

- Awareness: Sees a reel "Fix your horizon in 3 seconds" with live overlay demo. [4][13][34][56]
- Install → First session (<60s): Opens app, grants camera permission in-context, sees grid + horizon level immediately (no signup wall). [104][117][118][120][123]
- First win: Takes 3 photos; horizon snaps to lower third; subject dot turns green when aligned. [45][46][50][56]

- Day 2–3: Receives a push ("3-minute challenge: place your subject on the right-third dot 5 times"). Completes, earns a badge. [119][124][130]
- Day 7: Reviews before/after carousel; shares to Stories. Considers Pro when offered unlimited coaching at \$6.99/month. [71][74][134]
- Key metrics: Time-to-first-aligned-shot (<60s), D1/D7 retention, challenge completion, free→paid conversion. [36][71][74][117][119]

► Journey 2: Travel & Food Creator (consistency workflow)

- Awareness: Finds "Genre presets: Food vs Landscape" tutorial; installs. [5][33][43][67]
- Onboarding: Picks goals (Food + Travel), selects 2–3 preferences (overhead shots, sky/land balance). [117][118][120][123]
- Shoot session: Food preset suggests 45

► Prioritized Feature Backlog (Mapped to Personas)

► MVP (weeks 1–4) — serves all personas

- Live overlays: rule-of-thirds grid, horizon level, subject placement dot/box. [45][46][50][56][79]
- Light-direction prompts: simple arrows/text ("Shift so light hits from side"; "Reduce backlight"). [65][67]
- Angle/height nudges: "Try lower angle"; "Tilt slightly down to clean background." [5][33][43][45]
- Distraction highlights: mark clutter/photobombs/overexposed sky and suggest reframe. [45][65][67]
- Genre presets: Portrait / Landscape / Street / Food / Product (different priorities). [5][33][43][67]
- Progress: streaks, before/after comparisons, simple analytics (horizon aligned %, subject on-third %). [1][41]

► V2 (weeks 5–8) — deepens value for B/C/D

- AI coaching refinements: confidence indicators, fallback tips, genre-specific rubrics. [45][47][60][62]
- Advanced analytics: consistency score (B), deliberate-practice metrics (C), reshoot-rate tracking (D). [1][41][134][135][137]
- Community critiques (opt-in): structured rubric-based feedback. [22][41]
- Pricing tests: \$6.99 vs \$9.99/month; \$39.99–\$49.99/year; lifetime for pros. [71][73][74][76][81]

► Affinity Map (All Findings Clustered)

► Theme 1: In-the-moment guidance is the unmet need

- Users want live cues before capture, not just post-shot tips. [22][41][55][59]
- Deterministic overlays (grid, horizon) + simple prompts beat long explanations. [45][46][50][56][79]
- Light-direction and angle/height nudges are rare but high-value. [65][67][75]

► Theme 2: Composition is an observational skill gap

- Beginners know what looks good but can't reliably set it up. [5][33][65][75]
- Common errors: centered subjects, tilted horizons, messy backgrounds, no look room, eye-level-only. [5][33][38][43][65][67][75][79]
- Improvement comes from deliberate practice + feedback loops. [112][135][136]

► Theme 3: Trust and simplicity drive adoption

- Aggressive upsells, watermarks, and confusing trials kill trust. [16][23][27][30][60][62][66]
- Free core overlays + transparent pricing + no watermark on coaching builds goodwill. [60][62][66][71][74]
- Battery/latency fears require lite mode and throttled AI. [78][86][93]

► Theme 4: Genre-specific paths increase perceived value

- Portrait: eye on upper third + look room. [5][33]
- Landscape: foreground interest + horizon placement (sky upper third / land lower third). [5][33][63][67]
- Food: overhead 45

► Theme 5: Measurable progress fuels retention

- Streaks, badges, before/after carousels signal growth. [1][41][124][134][136]
- Simple analytics (horizon aligned %, subject on-third %) motivate continued use. [1][41][135]
- Community challenges and critiques add social accountability. [22][41][124]

► Theme 6: Market timing is favorable

- Smartphone photography dominates (75% of photos); heavy social sharing (68% within 24h). [134]
- AI editing is mainstream (30% use AI tools); users expect smart assistance. [133]
- Live coaching apps already ship (FrameUp, GudoCam, Klick), proving feasibility. [45][47][50][53][83][89][90][92]

► Theme 7: Pricing sensitivity varies by persona

- Social Sharer: \$4.99–\$6.99/month; high sensitivity to trials/watermarks. [71][74]
- Travel & Food Creator: \$6.99–\$9.99/month or \$39.99–\$49.99/year; values consistency tools. [71][73][74][76]
- Enthusiast Upgrader: \$6.99–\$9.99/month; open to annual with strong analytics. [71][74]
- Local Pro: \$39.99–\$79.99/year or lifetime; pays for reliability/time savings. [71][74][76][81]

► Next Steps (Validation → Build → Launch)

- Validate: 2-week concierge MVP (30 users, 7-day challenge) to confirm in-the-moment value and pricing. [36][71][74]
- Build: MVP in 4–6 weeks; beta test with 100 users; iterate on light/angle prompts and genre presets. [45][47][50][56]
- Launch: ASO + short-form content + community challenges; measure D1/D7/D30 retention and free→paid conversion. [36][39][71][74][117][119]